

CRESCENT LUNGE

Anjaneyasana

This lunge is a good antidote to sitting down too much. It is also beneficial for runners or anyone who participates in sports that involve running, because it strengthens the muscles that power your stride and stretches your hip flexors.

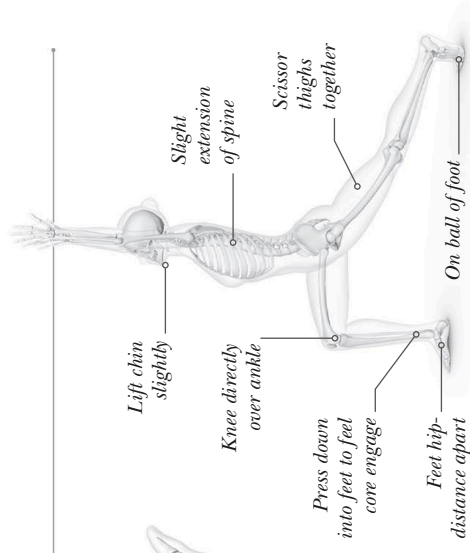
THE BIG PICTURE

In this pose, the muscles of your hips and your gluteus muscles stretch and activate dynamically to keep you balanced. Your thigh muscles engage strongly to stabilize your hips and knees, while your core muscles stabilize your spine in a slight backbend.

Neck

Your **cervical extensors** engage to extend your cervical spine while your **cervical flexors** engage and lengthen to stabilize your neck, preventing your head from dropping back.

Longus muscles
Sternocleidomastoid
Splenius muscles



ALIGNMENT

Your feet are hip-width apart to maintain balance. Your front knee is directly over your ankle or behind it for safety.

Elbow
Brachioradialis
Brachialis
Biceps brachii
Coracobrachialis
Deltoids
Shoulder
Serratus anterior

Arms

Your **shoulder flexors** engage. Your **anterior deltoids** aid in shoulder flexion while your **posterior deltoids** lengthen, yet some fibers engage to stabilize and externally rotate the shoulders. Your **triceps** extend the elbows. Feel space, not stiffness, in your joints as you reach through your fingers.

